Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

936
11 1.19%
Sep 6th, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1048
11.00 1.06%
Sep 6th, 2023

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

805
1 0.12%
Sep 6th, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

106.05
0.30 0.28%
Sep 6th, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

130.10
1.85 1.44%
Sep 6th, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

998
0 0.00%
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2401 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

853.50
7.00 0.83%
Sep 6th, 2023 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
October 23 USD/dmt

116.10
1.20 1.04%
Sep 6th, 2023 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2401 (Jan) RMB/t

3817
18 0.47%
Sep 6th, 2023 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

18.94
0.12 0.62%
Sep 5th, 2023

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

7.79
-0.16 -2.01%
Sep 5th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3770
40 1.07%
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

118.22
1.11 0.95%
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

12.39
-0.02 -0.14%
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3940
40 1.03%
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Sep 6th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	936	11	1.2%	869	880	858	892	121.36	1.16	1.0%	120.06	120.58	117.93	122.93
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	805	1	0.1%	813	798	761	793	104.99	-0.14	-0.1%	113.29	110.17	105.29	110.04
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1048	11	1.1%	981	992	970	1003	136.33	1.12	0.8%	136.05	136.43	133.84	138.73

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Sep 6th, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	106.05	0.30	0.28%	113.34	121.37	83.90	146.75
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	130.10	1.85	1.44%	122.59	135.53	94.45	147.55

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures rose by 0.12% today, the main contract closed at 853.5.The traders' willingness to ship is high.The steel mills are active to purchase.The overall trading sentiment of the market is more.PBF at Shandong port deal 915-917 yuan/mt,increase 5-7 yuan/mt. PBF at Tangshan port deal 920 yuan/mt,increase 6 yuan/mt. According to the news, the real estate sector in first tier cities is gradually recovering, and the sentiment in this sector has improved, which also supports the sentiment in the black market. As of today, the operating rate of blast furnaces surveyed by SMM is 93.46%, an increase of 0.3% compared to the previous period. The daily average iron production of the sample blast furnace steel plant increased slightly by 9000 tons, and the demand side has strengthened its support for ore prices. In addition, some steel mills' profits have recently been restored, supporting the enthusiasm for construction. We need to pay attention to the demand for finished products, and it is expected that the short-term mining prices will be strong and volatile.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	998	0	0.0%	936	1017	770	1026	124.50	0.21	0.17%	120.14	134.71	94.72	137.26

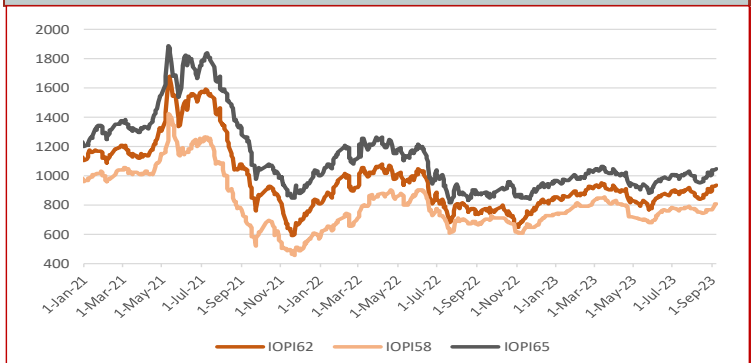
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1036	8.4%	779	1645	144.24	8.55%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1095	0.0%	780	1630	152.46	0.17%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	800	1.3%	620	1310	111.38	1.44%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1096	9.6%	800	1752	152.59	9.79%	117.19	272.32

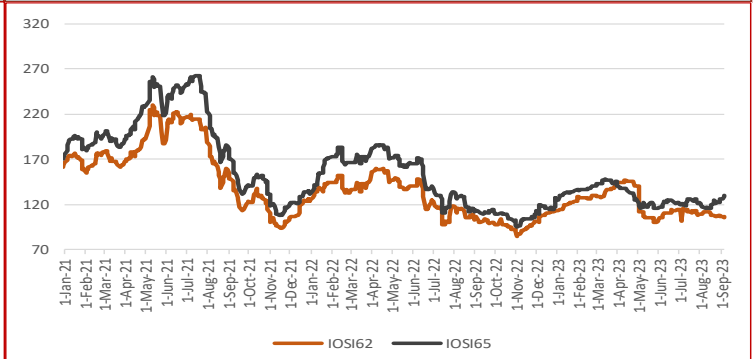
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	968.23	2.82%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.87528

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 6th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	804	863	896	873	869	881	880	106.85	112.38	116.58	113.28	120.06	120.90	120.58
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	698	748	777	759	813	792	798	93.21	97.98	101.68	99.13	113.29	109.35	110.17
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	916	975	1008	985	981	993	992	122.23	127.41	131.57	128.31	136.05	136.72	136.43

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 6th, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	108.53	110.54	108.57	109.02	112.14	113.12	121.37
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	127.20	135.30	147.39	119.61	122.86	122.73	135.53

FREIGHT RATES

Sep 5th, 2023		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	7.79	-0.16	-2.01%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	18.94	0.12	0.62%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	919	969	980	951	933	933	1017	117.67	121.33	122.51	118.96	119.96	120.16	134.98

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Sep 6th, 2023		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-131	-14.00%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	11.97%

Sep 6th, 2023		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	24.05	22.68%

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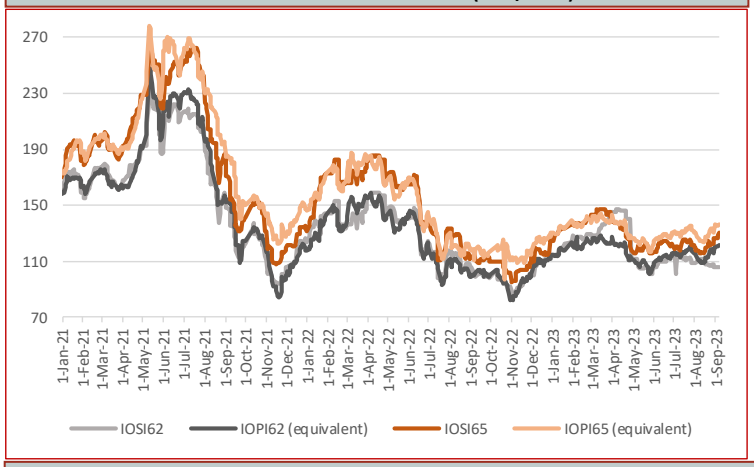
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Sep 6th, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	879	11	-57
SIMEC Fines	810	11	-126
PB Fines	903	11	-33
Newman Fines	905	11	-31
MAC Fines	886	11	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	801	11	-135
Carajas Fines	1117	11	181
Brazilian SSF	901	11	-35
Brazilian Blend Fines	917	11	-19
RTX Fines	819	11	-117
West Pilbara Fines	847	11	-89

Sep 6th, 2023	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	101.55	0.30	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	98.05	0.30	-8.00
PB Fines	102.30	0.30	-3.75
Newman Fines	105.20	0.30	-0.85
MAC Fines	102.30	0.30	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	94.70	0.30	-11.35
Carajas Fines	135.60	0.30	29.55
Brazilian SSF	109.80	0.30	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	111.45	0.30	5.40
RTX Fines	95.95	0.30	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	100.30	0.30	-5.75

Sep 6th, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	805	1	0
FMG Blended Fines	815	1	10
Robe River	816	1	11
Western Fines	819	1	14
Atlas Fines	812	1	7
Yandi	797	1	-8

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	21.00	1.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	-3.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	-3.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	-3.00
	Low Grade Fe	19.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	16.00	3.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	15.00	-5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	20.00	2.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	5.00	-5.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	20.00	5.00
	Low Fe Grade	14.00	-2.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	3.00	0.25
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	3.00	0.25
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	3.00	0.25
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	1.25	0.25
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	1.00	0.25
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	4.25	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.25	0.25
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.00	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	0.00	0.00	Jingtang	0.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-15.00	0.00

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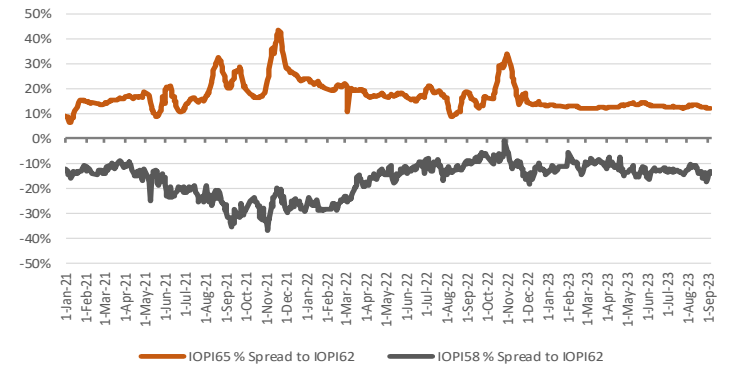
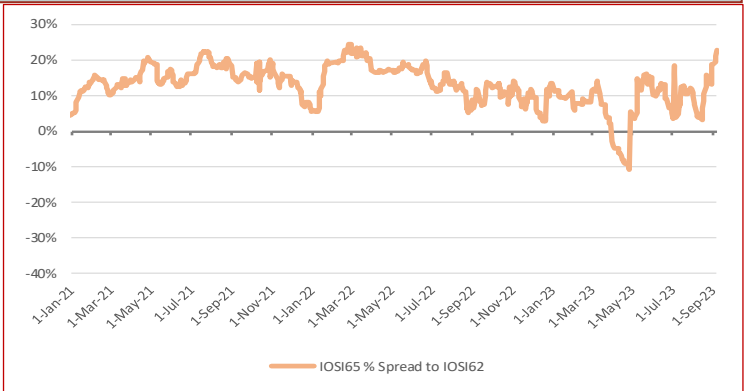
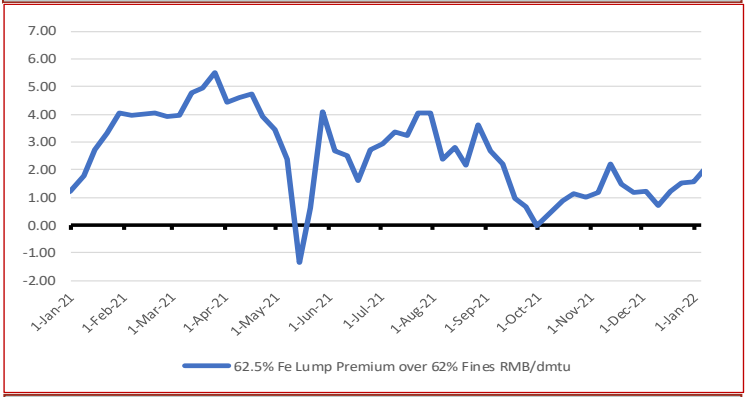
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

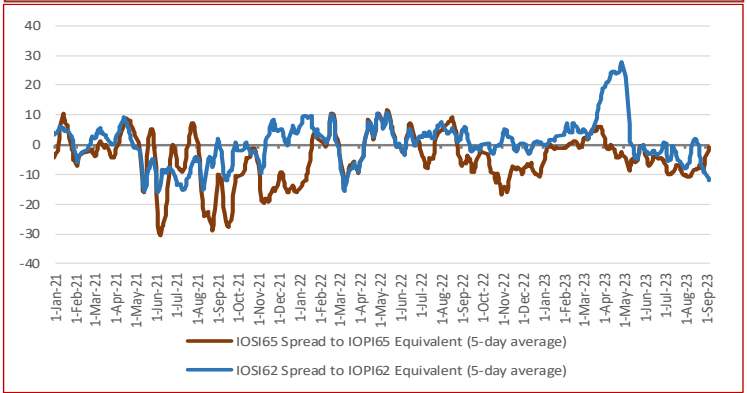




WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)

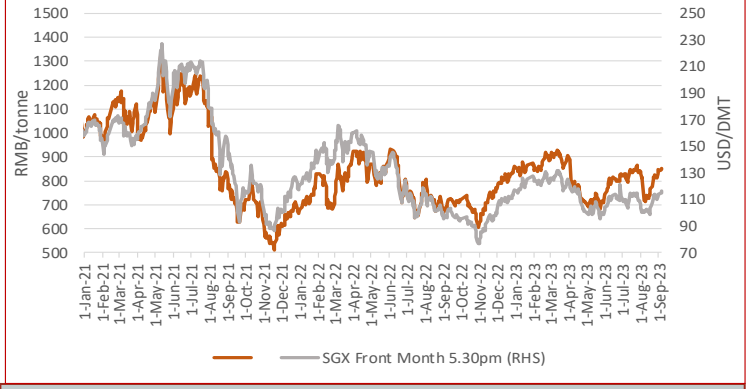


IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)

FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

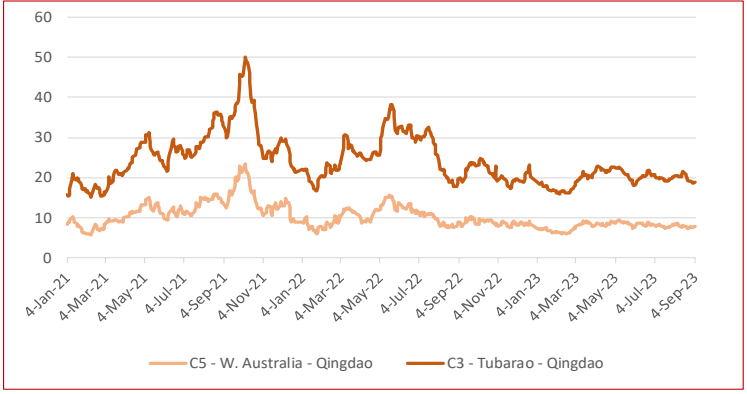
Week Ending Sep 1st, 2023

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	11.22	2.47%	9.84	19.20
Qingdao	24.16	-0.58%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	12.08	0.17%	9.05	16.29
Tianjin	8.99	-4.26%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	12.52	-2.57%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	118.22	0.95%	98.80	155.39

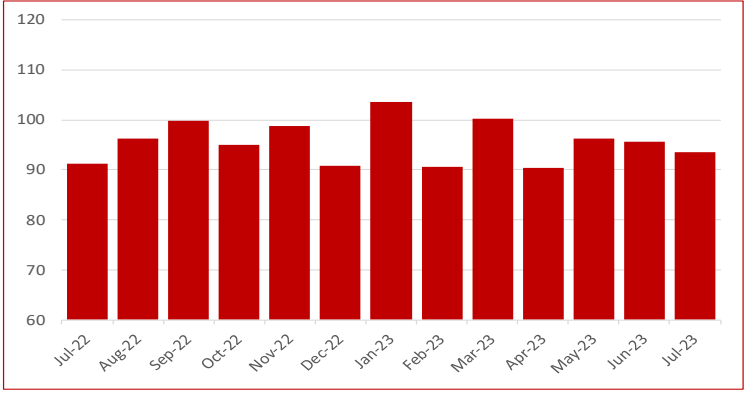
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Sep 6th, 3pm close			Sep 6th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2401	Change	Change %	Oct. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	853.50	7.00	0.83%	116.10	1.20	1.04%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	55.71	-2.43	-4.19%	7.62	-1.25	-14.12%
Open positions ('000 lots)	72.54	1.65	2.33%	34.70	0.18	0.52%
Day Low	844.0	1.00	0.12%	114.80	0.45	0.39%
Day High	858.5	-4.50	-0.52%	116.95	-0.30	-0.26%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2023/9/1	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,770	40	1.07%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,960	20	0.51%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,940	40	1.03%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,770	40	0.85%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,930	0	0.00%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,040	20	0.40%
Colour Coated Plate	6,950	-50	-0.71%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

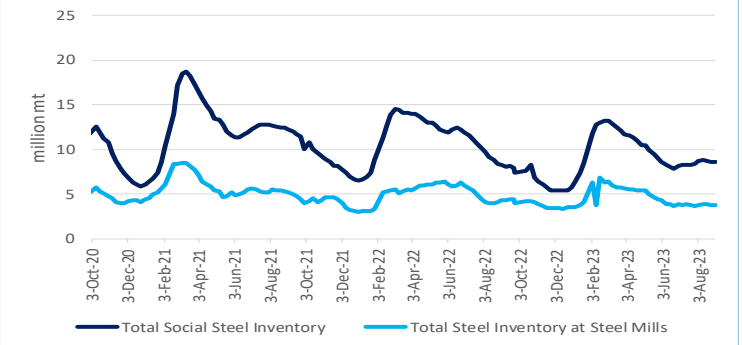
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	107.06	0	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,340	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,920	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,131	-159	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,764	13	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-94	17	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,817	45	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	113	-5	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

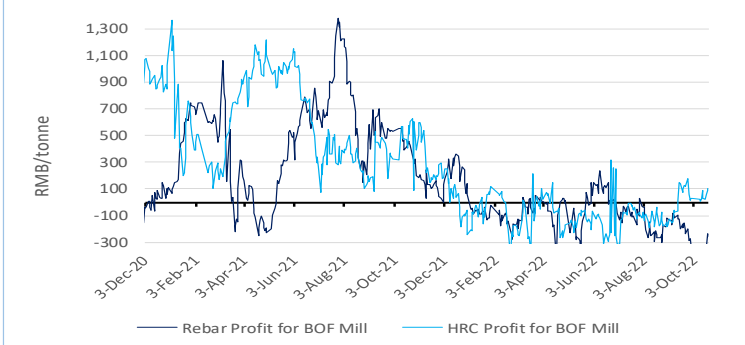
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

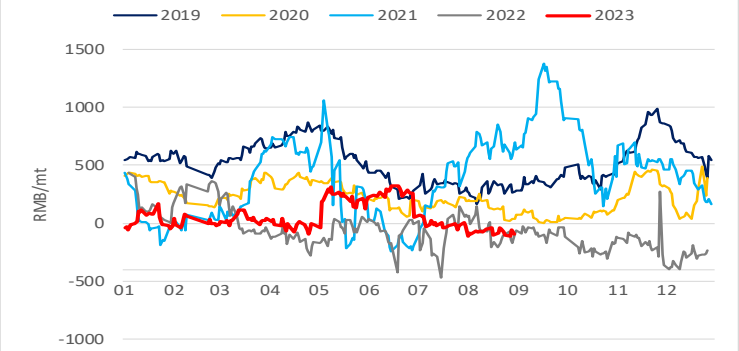
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



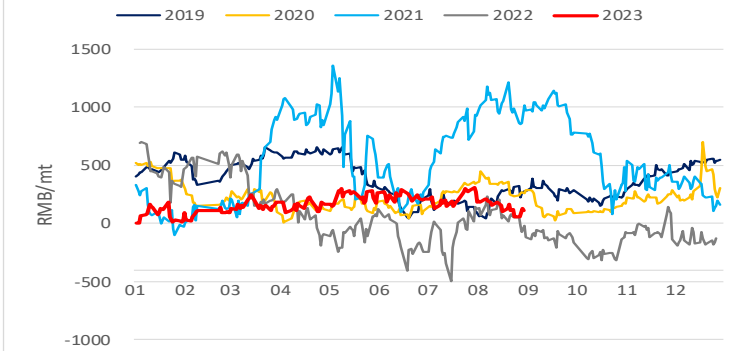
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



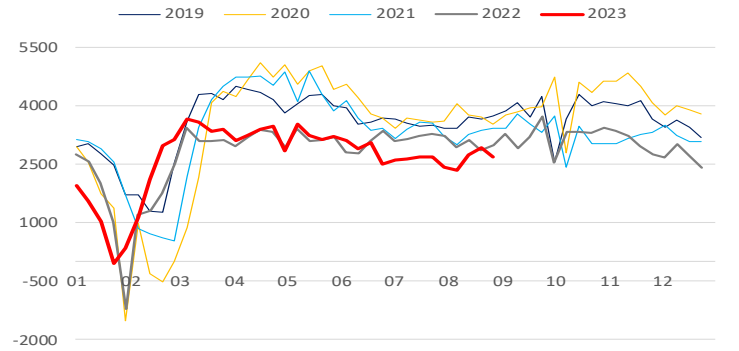
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



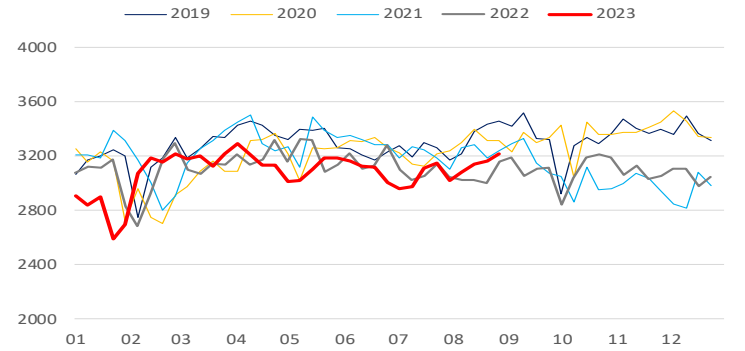
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



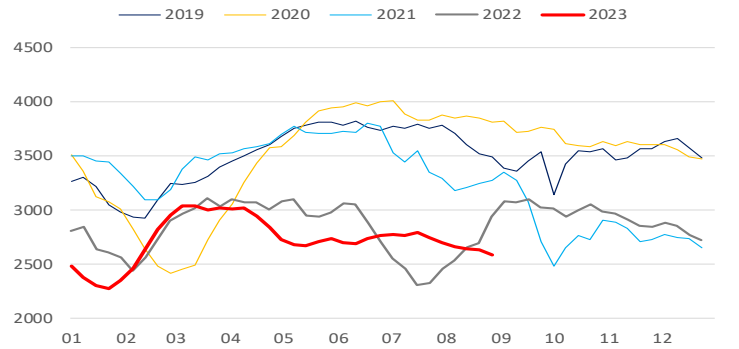
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



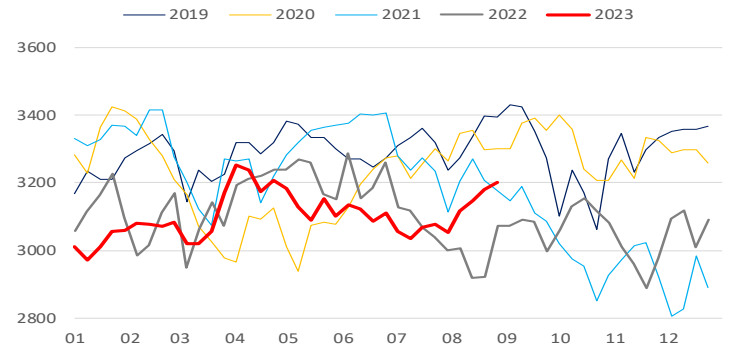
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Sep 6th, 2023	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Sep 6th, 2023	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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